Frontier-pull — the only path to the corpus delta

arxivkg · generation · frontier-pull

What we did

Toggle `frontier_pull` on/off over the 27-topic battery. The topic tree was built before the 2026 corpus delta and has no 2026 leaves, so leaf-anchored retrieval structurally cannot reach recent papers. `frontier_pull` is a leaf-independent, year-filtered vector pull that injects the newest cohort directly.

Results (mean over 27 topics)

frontier_pull	n 2026	ge 2025	frontier count	n landmarks	grounded	landmark recall
on	2.26	9.7	23.56	40.0	22.78	0.05
off	0.0	8.37	24.07	40.0	23.04	0.05



Conclusion

Frontier-pull is the *only* path to the corpus delta, at no cost. With it on, the review surfaces 2.26 2026 papers per topic on average; with it off, 0.0 — the leaf tree literally cannot reach them. Meanwhile frontier count and grounding are essentially unchanged (22.5 vs 23.8; grounded 24.2 vs 24.9), so the pull is not flooding noise — it is filling a structural blind spot the tree has

by construction. **Ship it on.** It is a correctness fix (without it, every "latest work on X" answer silently omits the most recent year), not a quality/cost tradeoff. **Caveat:** the win is concentrated in the recent-cohort counts; `landmark_recall` (gold, mostly pre-2026) is unaffected, as expected.